

a. What was the total amount of data that was stolen from the major contractor of FSB - Russia's Federal Security Service? (3 points)

The Forbes article states that, "the breach has been characterized as the largest known data breach in the history of the Russian intelligence services but does not specify the exact total amount of data stolen." But the article also said that it was estimated that the stolen data was around 7.5 Terabytes

b. What were included in the stolen data? (3 points)

The stolen data included project data related to various activities such as:

- "de-anonymizing Tor"
- "Surveillance of social media"
- "Regional mass surveillance."

c. What was the name of the contractor of FSB? (3 points)

The name of the contractor of FSB was SyTech.

d. What was the name of the hacking group? (3 points)

The name of the hacking group was OV1ru\$. But on twitter, it was called Digital Revolution.

e. What was left on the contractor's homepage during the breach? (3 points)

The hacking group left behind the message "Hacked by OV1ru\$" on SyTech's homepage and there was an emoji with a smug face.

f. In your perspective, who has greater negligence, FSB or the contractor? Justify your answer. (10 points)

Both the FSB and the contractor SyTech acted negligently, but arguably the contractor has more liability. The FSB, as the customer, has obligations to establish expectations of security, as well as possibly audit their contractors. SyTech, as the contractor, was responsible for the implementation and operation of security over their systems and data. The fact that sensitive project data was stolen, and their homepage was defaced indicates a significant lack of security on SyTech's behalf. We can make the logical assumption that basic security practices were not being applied and SyTech exhibited a greater level of negligence.

g. Based on your understanding, what phases of cybersecurity attack were reached by the hackers? Rationalize your answers. (10 points)

Based on my understanding, the hackers reached the following phases of a cybersecurity attack:

- **Reconnaissance:** The hackers likely gathered information about SyTech's systems and vulnerabilities before the attack. This is implied by their ability to target and breach the contractor.
- **Intrusion/Exploitation:** The hackers successfully breached SyTech's systems to steal data. This is evident from the data breach and the defacement of the homepage.
- **Data Exfiltration:** The hackers stole sensitive project data related to FSB activities.
- **Possibly, Impact:** Defacing the homepage can be considered an impact, as it disrupts the normal operation of the website and damages the reputation of the contractor.

h. In your perspective, what type of hackers were involved in the attack? Justify your answer. (10 points)

- **Hacktivists:** The group, OV1ru\$, left a message on the homepage, which suggests an element of activism or a desire to make a statement.
- **Black Hats:** The unauthorized access and theft of data clearly indicate malicious intent, aligning with the actions of black hat hackers.

i. How did the Digital Revolution group violate cybersecurity? (10 points)

The OV1ru\$ group violated cybersecurity by:

- **Unauthorized Access:** They gained unauthorized access to SyTech's systems.
- **Data Breach:** They stole sensitive and confidential data.
- **Defacement:** They defaced SyTech's homepage.

These actions violate the fundamental principles of confidentiality, integrity, and availability, which are central to cybersecurity.

j. What are the possible effects of this cybersecurity attack on the Russian intelligence service? Rationalize your answer. (10 points)

The possible effects of this cybersecurity attack on the Russian intelligence service include:

- **Compromised Operations:** The stolen data could reveal sensitive intelligence gathering methods and compromise ongoing operations.
- **Loss of Trust:** The breach could damage the reputation of the FSB and erode trust in its ability to protect sensitive information.

- **Financial Loss:** The FSB may incur costs related to investigating the breach, recovering from the damage, and improving security measures.
- **Reputational Damage:** This incident can tarnish the image of the Russian intelligence service both domestically and internationally.